



STORAGE (HARD DISK DRIVES)

Today, entry level hard disk prices are at a rock bottom level of just Rs 3,600, while prices of the largest capacity drives revolve around Rs 17,000 to 20,000. The 300 GB hard disk has hit the market. With the increase in size we've also seen an increase in speed, with drives as fast as 15,000 rpm. In this cutthroat environment, we tested various models from different hard disk manufacturers.

The 250 GB MaxLine Plus II wins hands down, be it features or performance—no other drive can match it. This was also the best performing drive in the entire spectrum of PATA and SATA hard disks taken together.

Excellent drive electronics and the 7,200 rpm spindle enabled this drive to give mind-bending performance in the SiSoft Sandra Tests. It gave excellent results in the sequential read and write speed test, with scores of 58 and 56 MBps—better than those of any of the SATA drives.

In the ATA category, nothing could really break the Maxtor MaxLine Plus II 250 GB drive in the real world tests. This drive lost

Maxtor's MaxLine Plus II 7Y250P0

+ 7200 rpm, ATA 133
– Expensive
Price: Rs 20,500
Contact: Cyberstar
Phone: 011-2643 8216
Fax: 011-2623 5460
E-mail: yogi@maxtor.com
Reviewed in: August 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Western Digital WD1000
2001: IBM Deskstar 60GXP 41 GB

out in the real world test to its SATA sibling because of its slightly higher CPU utilisation. In the Photoshop test, the MaxLine Plus II 250 GB took just 4 seconds to load Photoshop, and needed just 29 seconds to load the 200 MB test file. This can be attributed to the 8 MB of buffer memory, and the good read speed burst of 9 MBps.

All in all, we recommend this drive to users such as professional audio and video

WORTHY MENTIONS

Maxtor Diamond Max Plus9 6Y200M0
+ Low CPU utilisation, serial ATA, both types of power connector modes
– None
Price: Rs 14,200
Contact: Cyberstar
Phone: 011-2643 8216
Fax: : 011-2623 5460
E-mail: yogi@maxtor.com
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Samsung SpinPoint V Series SV1203N
+ ATA 133, lowest price per MB
– 5,400 rpm
Price: Rs 6,200
Contact: Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Ltd
Phone: 011-5151 1234
Fax: : 011-5160 8820
E-mail: hddsupport@samsungindia.com
Reviewed in: August 2003

editors, and gamers, who are always on the hunt for bigger capacity, faster drives that provide top-notch performance.

STORAGE (PORTABLE)

With advances in mobile computing and communications, the idea of a static workplace is slowly fading away. Today, a laptop lets you work at any time and place of your choice—be it a bus, train, inside a restaurant, etc. This makes it necessary to use light, convenient portable storage media to store data on the fly. Thumb drives and external hard drives have emerged as viable options in this media segment. They are easy to install and are durable as compared to other storage media. With improved interface standards such as USB 2.0 and FireWire, these devices are capable of transferring data efficiently and quickly, regardless of its type and size.

The EasyDisk was one of the lightest drives that we received. The real world tests saw it yielding faster data transfer rates as compared to other USB drives. Its performance was consistent and unswerving throughout the entire gamut of the testing process. A hardware switch enables you to use it alternatively as a floppy drive. There was no problem when connecting—Windows XP immediately

EasyDisk 128 MB

+ Consistent performance, inexpensive
– Uses USB 1.1, poor build quality
Price: Rs 3,500
Contact: GNH Systems
Phone: 022-2490 1333
Email: usbflashmemory@hotmail.com
Reviewed In: December 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Freecom FHD-1 20 GB
2001: NA

recognised it as a removable hard drive, and also as a second floppy drive. You can also use it as a bootable media if your BIOS permits.

Bundled along are software such as Passid, a password protection tool, and Flash Mail—a utility that integrates well with Microsoft Outlook.

WORTHY MENTIONS

Freecom FHD-1 40GB external hard drive
+ Excellent data transfer rates, good build quality
– High price, quite a heavy drive
Price: Rs 13,500
Contact: J. S. Equipments
Phone: 022-2381 0713
E-mail: jse@vsnl.com
Reviewed In: December 2003

Transcend TS40GHDENC 40GB
+ Good data transfer rates, inexpensive, genuine leather carry case
– No additional software bundled
Price: Rs 11,000
Contact: Wales Technologies
Phone: 022-2382 8100
E-mail: sales@mediamangroup.com
Reviewed In: December 2003

Note: Look for our external storage comparison test in the Digit January 2004 issue

The EasyDisk 128 MB drive was the clear winner among the thumb drives, primarily due to its more-than-adequate software bundle, as well as its reliable, decent performance.